SPORTS CONTENT PLAYBOOK

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The Moment Playbook

How to plan six key moments in a club's season, with real examples from the Sports Content Playbook library, hooks to adapt and a checklist for each.

How to use this playbook

For community managers at clubs, federations, academies and sports brands, in any sport and at any size.

1. Pick the moment that comes next in your calendar.
2. Read the real examples, then the plan.
3. Adapt the hook to your sport, your voice and your own footage.
4. Run the checklist before you publish. One call to action per post.

Where the examples come from

Every example is a real post recorded in the Sports Content Playbook library (over 680,000 pieces of sports content). We show the account, platform, date, views and likes recorded by the library and what we observed. The examples come from large clubs and leagues, because those are the accounts with the most public data, so what could work for a smaller club is labelled as a hypothesis.

How to read the data

- **Observed:** what is visible in the post and its public numbers.
- **Hypothesis:** our reading of why it works. Test it with your own audience.
- Views depend on account size. These numbers show a pattern, not a benchmark for your club.

The 6 moments

Moment	Core idea
Match day	One reason to care before, the moment during, the reaction after.
Signing or announcement	The announcement is the start of the story, not the end.
Return and welcome back	Respect first, story second. Never guess a timeline.
Club history and 'on this day'	A person, an object and a date: 30 seconds.
Academy and youth	Make the next generation part of the club identity; safeguarding first.
Tickets and membership	Turn the numbers into an invitation and one action.

MOMENT 1 OF 6

Match day

One reason to care before, the moment during, the reaction after.

Real examples from the library

@nufc · TikTok · 07/01/2026 · 4.8M views · 143K likes
tiktok.com/@nufc/video/7592697263604976918
Observed: the caption is one line ('We go again tonight') with no fixture details or lineup.

@atleticodemadrid · TikTok · 27/06/2026 · 4.1M views · 577K likes
tiktok.com/@atleticodemadrid/video/7656175967584423190
Observed: the caption links the stadium moment to a pop-culture reference ('The Army bomb shines red and white tonight') instead of announcing the fixture.

Plan

- Before: one reason to care (stakes, a player, a return) in the first line, with kick-off time.
- During: one clip per key moment, posted fast, with score and minute in the caption.
- After: the one moment fans will share, plus a short reaction from a player or coach.

Hook templates

The one thing that decides tonight.

Watch [player] in the first 15 minutes.

[Minute]: the moment the match changed.

Adapt it

Hypothesis: both captions rely on one idea and little text. A small club can do the same with 10 seconds of the tunnel, the warm-up or a fan, filmed on a phone.

Other sports and sizes: Handball and basketball: use the quarter or half as the moment ('Q3, 6-0 run'). Federations: use the match-day atmosphere and the venue.

Checklist: Match day

Print it, tick it, publish.

☐ The first line says why this match matters.

☐ Kick-off time and venue are correct.

☐ One clip is ready before the whistle.

☐ A person (player, coach, fan) appears in the first 2 seconds.

Metric to review a week later: views, saves, shares and clicks for this post, compared with your last 5 posts of the same format.

MOMENT 2 OF 6

Signing or announcement

The announcement is the start of the story, not the end.

Real examples from the library

@realmadrid · TikTok · 10/08/2026 · 4.7M views · 926K likes
tiktok.com/@realmadrid/video/7672374686013082902
Observed: the caption frames the arrival around the player's status ('a welcome fit for a world champion') and tags him; it is a video post, not a graphic.

Plan

- Teaser 24 hours before: a detail only fans will recognize (never the name).
- Reveal: the player's first words or first steps in the stadium.
- Follow-up (3 days): first training, a fan question, the city.

Hook templates

He just landed. Guess who.

[Player] in 10 seconds: three things to know.

What [player] said walking into the stadium.

Adapt it

Hypothesis: a video with the player tends to carry more than a graphic. For amateur and women's teams, a 15-second video of the new player meeting the squad is enough.

Other sports and sizes: Individual sports and federations: use 'selected for' and 'joins the national team' with the same structure.

Checklist: Signing or announcement

Print it, tick it, publish.

☐ Contract and image approval confirmed.

☐ A teaser and a reveal planned, with time between them.

☐ The player appears in the video, not only the name.

☐ Captions and subtitles checked for spelling of the name.

Metric to review a week later: views, saves, shares and clicks for this post, compared with your last 5 posts of the same format.

MOMENT 3 OF 6

Return and welcome back

Respect first, story second. Never guess a timeline.

Real examples from the library

@fcbarcelona · TikTok · 04/01/2026 · 4.0M views · 683K likes
tiktok.com/@fcbarcelona/video/7591298359382527254
Observed: the caption is two words and a name ('Welcome back, Olmo.'), with no medical details or timeline.

Plan

- Use only what the club has confirmed; never estimate recovery time.
- Show the work: physio, gym, first ball touch, with the player's consent.
- On the return: first minute on the pitch and the squad's reaction.

Hook templates

Day one back on the grass for [player].

What recovery looks like when nobody is watching.

[Player]'s first training with the group.

Adapt it

Hypothesis: a short, warm message works better than detail. Smaller clubs can use a 10-second clip of teammates welcoming the player.

Other sports and sizes: Individual sports: same structure with the training block and the first competition back.

Checklist: Return and welcome back

Print it, tick it, publish.

☐ Medical information confirmed and approved.

☐ Player consent for the clips.

☐ No timeline or rumour in the caption.

☐ A teammate or coach voice if possible.

Metric to review a week later: views, saves, shares and clicks for this post, compared with your last 5 posts of the same format.

MOMENT 4 OF 6

Club history and 'on this day'

A person, an object and a date: 30 seconds.

Real examples from the library

@mancity · TikTok · 11/02/2026 · 4.4M views · 266K likes
tiktok.com/@mancity/video/7605170594044349719
Observed: the caption uses a date ('On this day in 2024') and one player name: one date, one moment.

@laliga · TikTok · 31/12/2025 · 4.4M views · 134K likes
tiktok.com/@laliga/video/7589697017723505942
Observed: the caption is a player's name plus a history hashtag (#LALIGAHistory): very little text, the archive carries the post.

Plan

- Pick one person, one object and one date.
- Use the archive clip first, then a modern shot in the same place.
- Close with a question to fans: where were you?

Hook templates

In [year], this goal changed [club].

This shirt was worn only once. Here is why.

[Number] years ago today, this stadium opened.

Adapt it

Hypothesis: the date can be the hook. Clubs with little footage can use match photos with a voice-over from a long-time member.

Other sports and sizes: Handball, basketball, federations: use the first title, a record or the opening of the venue.

Checklist: Club history and 'on this day'

Print it, tick it, publish.

☐ Date verified in a source.

☐ Image and footage rights cleared.

☐ One person, one object, one date.

☐ A question for fans at the end.

Metric to review a week later: views, saves, shares and clicks for this post, compared with your last 5 posts of the same format.

MOMENT 5 OF 6

Academy and youth

Make the next generation part of the club identity; safeguarding first.

Real examples from the library

@realmadrid · TikTok · 20/04/2026 · 7.0M views · 920K likes
tiktok.com/@realmadrid/video/7630818279728090390
Observed: the caption of the youth team's UEFA Youth League moment names the player and tags the youth team (#JuvenilA).

Plan

- Check image rights and consent for every minor before posting.
- Show the path: from the academy to the first team.
- Give the coach a voice: one thing a young player must learn.

Hook templates

From the academy to the first team: [number] steps.

A day at the academy in 30 seconds.

Meet the [age group] team that won [competition].

Adapt it

Hypothesis: naming the player and the competition gives the post a clear story. Check consent and the safeguarding policy for every minor first.

Other sports and sizes: Federations and schools: tournament days and 'players to watch' with parental consent.

Checklist: Academy and youth

Print it, tick it, publish.

☐ Written consent for every minor.

☐ No location, school or personal details.

☐ Coach quote approved.

☐ Safeguarding policy checked.

Metric to review a week later: views, saves, shares and clicks for this post, compared with your last 5 posts of the same format.

MOMENT 6 OF 6

Tickets and membership

Turn the numbers into an invitation and one action.

Real examples from the library

@mancity · TikTok · 21/07/2026 · 316K views · 36K likes
tiktok.com/@mancity/video/7664960049533553942
Observed: the caption is a plain announcement ('tickets are now on sale to Official Members') with who it is for and what to do.

Plan

- Tell fans who it is for, when it opens and what to do, in the first line.
- Celebrate with a person (a long-time member, a volunteer), not a graphic.
- One action only: link, code or visit.

Hook templates

Tickets are on sale for [match]. Here is how.

The fan who has not missed a match in [years].

Thank you to the [number] who came on Sunday.

Adapt it

Hypothesis: for sales posts, clarity is the priority. Smaller clubs benefit from a face and a date.

Other sports and sizes: Federations and events: use the registration or qualification date as the moment.

Checklist: Tickets and membership

Print it, tick it, publish.

☐ Dates, prices and links verified.

☐ Who it is for stated in the first line.

☐ One call to action.

☐ A person visible in the video.

Metric to review a week later: views, saves, shares and clicks for this post, compared with your last 5 posts of the same format.

Turn it into a weekly system

The playbook works when it is on the calendar.

- Add the next 4 moments of your season to a shared calendar.
- For each, assign who films, who edits and who approves.
- Review each post a week later and keep what works for your audience.

SPORTS CONTENT PLAYBOOK

Try Sports Content Playbook.

Browse thousands of real sports posts from clubs, federations and brands, see the hook and the format, and plan your own content in one place.

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Examples and numbers: Sports Content Playbook library, recorded 26 Oct 2026. Hooks and checklists are original to Sports Content Playbook. Always verify facts, image rights and approvals before publishing.